

Web Application Project Proposal(MERN Stack)

1. Project Title

Recovery Compass — A Post-Disaster Financial Recovery Planner

2. Problem Statement

After floods, cyclones, or economic shocks — common occurrences in Bangladesh — families often lose track of their finances entirely and struggle to rebuild, with no structured way to plan their recovery.

- **Who is affected?** Individuals and families in disaster-prone regions who lose their financial footing after a crisis and have no clear picture of their remaining resources, spending, or aid received.
 - **Current challenges or limitations:** After a disaster, financial records are often lost or abandoned entirely. People are left estimating from memory, with no way to track essential vs. non-essential spending or measure how far they are from their pre-crisis income level.
 - **Why existing solutions are insufficient:** Regular budgeting apps assume a stable financial baseline and focus on generic spending charts. They are not built to help someone reconstruct their finances from scratch or measure recovery relative to a pre-crisis income, and offer no way to log aid received during a crisis.
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3. Proposed Solution

Recovery Compass is a simple, self-hosted financial recovery tracker built on the MERN stack (MongoDB, Express.js, React, Node.js) that helps disaster-affected individuals reconstruct their financial picture from scratch and plan a path back to stability.

- **Core idea:** A focused web app where users log remaining resources, essential vs. non-essential spending, and aid received, then view a dashboard built around recovery progress instead of generic budgeting charts.
 - **Target users:** Individuals and families recovering from floods, cyclones, or economic shocks who need a structured way to rebuild their finances without linking real bank accounts.
 - **Value the system provides:** A clear recovery target based on pre-crisis income, a simple way to separate essential from non-essential spending during recovery, and a centralized view that answers “how close am I to getting back on my feet?”
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4. Features & Functional Requirements

- **Add Income** — Users can log income entries, including aid received, with amount, source, and date.
- **Add Expense** — Users can log an expense tagged as essential or non-essential, with amount, category, and date.
- **Set Baseline** — Users can enter their pre-crisis monthly income, which becomes the target for measuring recovery.
- **Recovery Dashboard** — A central summary view showing recovery progress against the pre-crisis baseline, essential vs. non-essential spending, total aid received, and remaining resources.